The leaders of the group said that the TULF leadership had once craved Eelam but today were slaves of the Sinhalese in parliament. The bitterness between the two groups was so strong that they started targeting each other to assert supremacy. Amid the growing animosity between the Sinhalese and the Tamils, Indian President Sanjiva Reddy visited Sri Lanka between 2 and 7 February 1982. Reddy was the guest of honour at the 34th anniversary celebrations of Sri Lanka's independence held at Anuradhapura. There, the Indian president remarked that prosperity for people of Indian origins lay in the prosperity of their adopted country and he was happy to note that the those who had decided to make Sri Lanka their home were making significant contributions to the country. Reddy said:

Our two countries have remained close to each other throughout history, sharing a common culture, inheriting a common civilization. We are convinced

that these ties which have withstood the vicissitudes of time and foreign rule will grow even stronger in the years to come.

Just a week after Reddy's visit, on 13 February, the Tigers allegedly shot an army driver in the north of the island, threatening the fragile peace in the region. The official statement issued by the Sri Lankan government said the objective of the terrorists had been to provoke the security personnel stationed in Jaffna to retaliate and to cause further estrangement between the army and the public. Although the Sri Lankan army had taken special care to prevent souring its relations with the civilian public, there were complaints from political leaders against the rough handling received by Tamil residents during the searches.